



Google Maps back on iOS

After Apple removed Google Maps a few months back and faced embarrassment, it's back again on the App Store

'Nearby' feature updated

The 'Nearby' feature for Facebook's apps for iOS and Android has been included with discover and share features for finding places easily

Securing Self

We speak with McAfee on the future of security, its acquisition by Intel and more...

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Q Intel as we all know is a hardware company and it has acquired McAfee, a software player. What has changed since Intel's acquisition of McAfee in terms of work culture, roadmaps, etc.?

On a higher level, Intel has a history of solving computing's biggest challenges. They've been focused on energy-efficient performance, connectivity, and now security. For Intel, Security is their "third pillar of computing." Unless we can solve the problem of keeping computers secure, we'll never live up to the Internet's full potential. If we can solve it, it will be an enabler to growth in the computing industry and will allow Intel to achieve its goals related to transparent computing and the compute continuum.

Q Considering Intel is into chip making and hardware, is McAfee designing any products in collaboration with Intel?

The Intel and McAfee integration falls into two main areas: 1) co-design efforts, and 2) go-to-market efforts. McAfee Deep Defender and McAfee ePO Deep Command are both co-design efforts, and there are many areas that we can point to where those efforts continue. Security on Ultrabooks is an example of a go-to-market effort. McAfee is working to improve performance of security on Ultrabooks by leveraging the graphics processor and in-built encryption provided within the Intel hardware and producing dramatic results in the area of performance for example. On machines that run the i5+ processors, Intel and McAfee have partnered to release an Ultrafast, UltraSecure Anti-theft solution that will allow customers to remotely control and retrieve data and device – something that no one else in the industry can do today.

Q Which platforms drive the sales of your security offerings for mobile? Effectively,



Steve Petracca, Sr. VP and GM for Consumer and Mobile Business, McAfee

does that imply that they are less secure, or simply popular?

At this point it does seem that Android is driving a significant portion of what we sell. The reasons are due to the higher adoption and the opportunities for hackers on an operating system that is open. Cyber crime is all about opportunity in proportion to volumes. It is a volume game. The more you are able to target the higher the chances of getting your victims.

Q Are security offerings relevant anymore? Do mobile users need such offerings if app stores have stringent policies to safeguard their users?

Indeed they are. There is enough evidence that seems to suggest that whatever app stores do to control the quality of the applications they host, the sheer numbers of applications that get hosted and updated is so high it is very difficult for them to have a system that guarantees zero threat. There have been many instances of malicious apps getting downloaded from these stores and it's days before they are discovered and plugged.

Additionally there are other stores that host copies of the applications of the major players like Google and customers downloading from those links are vulnerable. So in this situation, one needs to be vigilant and not blindly trust any application they download – regardless of the Store reputation.

Q Could you tell us something about McAfee All Access 2013. I think this is a first of its kind product which offers protection across all platforms – PCs, Macs, smartphones, tablets and so on with one product. How and why did McAfee come up with such a product? What advantages does it offer over stand-alone security suites for each of these platforms?

McAfee All Access (MAA) is a cross platform offering to users to protect multiple devices that they might own. We were first in the market with a product offering that protects multiple devices with a single SKU. We noticed that with the explosion of devices in the market a typical home no longer had a desktop or a PC – but had many devices that stored/manipulated electronic data including smartphones and tablets. It is not unusual for a home to have as many as 15-20 devices today. This clearly brought about a need to be able to service multiple devices from a Security standpoint seamlessly and with the least hassle to the user. This resulted in the evolution of McAfee All Access. This product provides a single SKU provides license to use the products McAfee offers on the various platforms and helps manage the various devices as well thought an integrated console on our the users account on our home.mcafee.com website. **Q**

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